

800s. Abu ’Uthman Amr’ ibn Bahr (known as al-Jahiz) makes the first known description of a food chain.

1859. Charles Darwin describes food webs in his On the Origin of Species.

1927. Charles Elton develops the idea of the food web in Animal Ecology and introduces the concept of the ecological niche.

1935. Arthur G. Tansley coins the term ecosystem, arguing that an environment and all its living organisms have to be seen as a single, interactive whole.

1942. The journal Ecology posthumously publishes Raymond Lindeman’s article “The trophic-dynamic aspect of ecology”.